

Nick Sannen

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Internationally experienced commercial professional with a strong background in partnership management, high-value sales and distributor development. Over fifteen years connecting brands, athletes and commercial opportunities across cycling and motorsport, including founding and building two professional gravel teams from scratch. A strategic relationship builder with an entrepreneurial mindset, effective across marketing, sales and operations, and most at home with full ownership of a project.

KEY SKILLS & EXPERTISE

Partnership Management - High-Value Sales - Sponsorship Acquisition - Distributor Development - B2B Relationship Management - Contract Negotiation - Team Building - Athlete Management - Budget Management - Race & Event Logistics - Content Strategy - Storytelling - Brand Positioning - Marketing & Communications - Event Activations - Trade Shows

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

Foodmaker X Gravel King 2026-Present

Founder & GM

Founded and built a new professional gravel team from scratch, taking full ownership across strategy, commercial, content and sport.

- Led all commercial partnerships, securing and managing collaborations with multiple international brands.
- Developed and executed the full content and communication strategy, covering storytelling, announcements and brand positioning.
- Managed rider recruitment and contracts, building a competitive and professional team structure.
- Integrated an existing cycling community, TNS, into the team, increasing visibility and delivering measurable value for partners.
- Owned overall strategy, budget allocation and the long-term development of the project.

Classified x Rose 2023-2026

Team / Athlete Manager & Founder

Founded and built a professional gravel team from the ground up, overseeing all operational and sporting aspects while owning the commercial and brand side for Classified.

- Managed athlete contracts, logistics, race planning and performance support.
- Secured sponsorships and commercial partnerships, contributing directly to revenue growth and financial sustainability.
- Led marketing and communications, driving visibility and credibility for the team.
- Visited dealers and distributors to present the team concept, gather market feedback and strengthen distribution relationships.
- Translated market insights into strategic actions in collaboration with marketing and product teams.

Classified 2021-2023

Athlete Manager & Event Manager

Managed athlete relations and ran events, trade shows and activations end to end, owning on-site sales and distributor activation.

- Acted as the main contact point for athletes, ensuring their needs were met and creating content opportunities aligned to brand strategy.
- Organised events, trade shows and activations, from venue booking to full on-site execution.

- Oversaw sales logistics and managed on-site sales operations during trade shows, ensuring commercial targets were met.
- Supported distributor activation by aligning brand presence with local sales objectives.

Paul Sannen bv 2008-2021

Manager / Partnerships & Operations

Led high-value commercial negotiations and long-term partnerships across elite motorsport and cycling, alongside ultra-premium vehicle sales.

- Led commercial negotiations with international brands and private clients in elite motorsport and cycling environments.
- Handled luxury vehicle sales in the ultra-high-end segment, with transactions exceeding EUR 500,000, built on trust-based relationship management.
- Developed and maintained long-term B2B relationships with sponsors, partners and rights holders across multiple markets.
- Negotiated partnership agreements and ensured contractual delivery and commercial performance.

Nicky Hayden, MotoGP 2011-2017

Personal Assistant

- Supported a top-level MotoGP rider across customer relations and events.

Tom Boonen 2010-2011

Personal Assistant

- Provided personal assistance to one of Belgium's leading professional cyclists.

ADDITIONAL

Languages: Dutch (native), English (very good), French (basic), German (notions)

Licences: Driving licences B, C & CE

Personal Interests: Cycling, gravel, running, motorsport

Personal: Belgian, based in Meerhout. Born 08/03/1985.

EDUCATION & QUALIFICATIONS

Physical Education and Sport - Rozenberg, Mol (1997-2005)

Driving Licences B, C & CE - car, truck and truck-with-trailer categories